

CRISTIAN ARIEL CUSUMANO

Senior Game Engineer | Technical Artist | Full Stack Developer

Santos, São Paulo, Brazil • cusumdt@gmail.com • +55 13 9 8192 3786
linkedin.com/in/cristian-cusumano-524ab1195 • cusu-dev.vercel.app • artstation.com/cusumdt

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Game Engineer and Technical Artist with 9+ years of experience bridging code and art to ship interactive experiences. Currently leading the technical architecture of Unreal Engine 5 VR/AR projects, with a proven track record across mobile games, real-time web 3D platforms, and educational software for high-profile clients including Mercedes-Benz, Disney, Chevrolet, and Oh Baby Games (Australia). Hybrid profile combining programming (C++, C#, Python, SQL, JavaScript) with 3D art, shader work, and pipeline engineering. Also ships and maintains commercial Blender tooling as an independent developer. International experience with teams across Australia, Spain, Argentina, and Brazil. Native Spanish, fluent Portuguese, professional written English.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming	C++, C#, Python, SQL, JavaScript, Blueprints, HLSL, Git
Engines & Real-time	Unreal Engine 5 (Certified), Unity (7+ years), VR/AR, Lumen, Nanite, Niagara, WebGL, Three.js
3D & Art Tools	Blender, Substance Painter, Substance Designer, Maya, ZBrush, Photoshop, Illustrator
Tooling & DCC Dev	Blender addon development (Python / bpy), JetBrains Rider, Visual Studio, Figma
Specializations	Technical Art, Real-time Rendering, Shaders, Performance Profiling & Optimization, Asset Pipelines, Mobile & VR Optimization, Database Design
Languages	Spanish (Native), Portuguese (Fluent), English (Professional working)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Game Engineer

Agência DADS • Santos, Brazil • April 2026 – Present

- Lead the technical architecture of Unreal Engine 5 projects, with performance and scalability as the primary constraint across target platforms
- Build a high-fidelity PC VR truck showroom experience (Mercedes-Benz Actros), including a server-driven configurator UI for real-time switching of cabin, chassis, lighting and trailer variants
- Rebuilt the CAD-to-engine asset pipeline: decimation and retopology of raw 14-15M triangle meshes, material consolidation, and texture streaming budget management to eliminate memory overruns
- Modified the Unreal shader and mesh importer to remove UE5's normal recast, making Blender and UE5 shading match exactly and eliminating recurring normal artifacts across all assets
- Diagnose and resolve rendering issues in stereo VR: virtual shadow map overflow, Lumen artifacts, texture streaming pool exhaustion, silent scalability drops, and DLSS/Streamline plugin conflicts
- Own engine version migrations (UE 5.5 to 5.7) and validate lighting, materials and performance after each upgrade
- Define tasks and test plans for junior programmers and produce technical documentation and reports in Portuguese

Founder & Developer

CusuTools • Independent • June 2026 – Present

- Design, develop and ship commercial Blender addons for 3D artists and game developers, handling the full product cycle: market research, development, release, support and updates
- Released **TexelPack**, a UV packing and texel density addon distributed on Superhive Market, including texel density map export as an image for UV layout inspection
- Currently developing **PreflightKit**, a pre-flight asset validator that checks and exports game-ready assets, catching pipeline errors before they reach the engine
- Run the business side end to end: pricing, storefront, customer support, refunds, and affiliate and creator outreach

Co-Founder

Bird • Santos, Brazil • August 2025 – Present

- Co-founded a small studio offering marketing management, web systems and applications for micro-entrepreneurs; contribute on the technical side of client websites and web apps

Developer / 3D Artist

Oh Baby Games • Remote (Australia) • July 2022 – February 2025

- Developed mobile racing games in Unity for international markets, working with licensed IPs including SpongeBob SquarePants, Invader Zim, and Tower of God
- Created complete 3D environments from concept to implementation: modeled buildings, props, and environmental elements; textured assets; implemented lighting and atmospheric effects
- Optimized 3D assets and rendering pipeline to maintain 60fps on mid-range mobile devices while preserving visual quality
- Programmed gameplay mechanics, UI systems, and interactive elements in C#
- Collaborated with an international team across time zones using Agile methodologies

Freelance Web 3D Developer

Chevrolet Project • Remote (Argentina) • September 2023 – April 2024

- Developed an interactive web 3D platform for vehicle visualization using WebGL and Three.js
- Implemented a real-time customization system allowing users to change colors, wheels, and components
- Optimized rendering performance for a smooth browser-based 3D experience across desktop and mobile
- Collaborated iteratively with design and product teams, adapting features based on client feedback

Project Manager & Unity Developer

Inflexion Studios • Remote (Spain) • October 2021 – June 2022

- Led project management and technical development for real-time interactive experience projects
- Coordinated multidisciplinary teams of designers, developers, and artists across the project lifecycle
- Managed scope, timelines and deliverables while keeping a hands-on Unity development role
- Established technical and artistic pipelines for efficient asset integration and optimization
- Served as the bridge between clients and the development team, translating requirements into technical solutions

Lead Artist, Art Director & Unity Developer

DIGI Learnnials (Disney Partnership) • Argentina • February 2020 – December 2021

- Led art direction and Unity WebGL development for an educational platform built for Disney
- Directed a team of 6 artists creating character designs and visual assets for children ages 8-11

- Developed an interactive scene and character editor in C# allowing students to create narrative arcs
- Implemented a teacher dashboard and activity creation tools for classroom integration
- Collaborated with educational experts to ensure the platform met pedagogical standards
- Established the art style and production pipeline, ensuring consistency across culturally diverse characters

Professor - 3D Art & Database Programming

Image Campus • Buenos Aires, Argentina • March 2021 – February 2023

- Taught 3D Art, Unity, Blender, shaders, and object-oriented programming to game development students
- Instructed database design, SQL optimization, and data structures courses
- Developed curriculum combining technical skills with practical industry applications

Database Programmer

Toyota Argentina • Argentina • February 2017 – October 2019

- Developed and maintained internal database systems for business operations
- Optimized SQL queries and database structures to improve system performance
- Provided technical support and data analysis for various departments
- Collaborated with technical and administrative teams in a corporate environment

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Unreal Engine Certification

Certified in Unreal Engine development, Blueprints, and C++

Higher Technician in Video Game Development

Image Campus • Buenos Aires, Argentina • 2018 – 2020

Technical Degree in Computer Programming

Escuela Técnica N.º 1 Raúl Scalabrini Ortiz • Argentina • 2011 – 2017

KEY STRENGTHS

- **Hybrid Technical Profile:** bridges programming and art, enabling effective communication between technical and creative teams
- **Full Pipeline Ownership:** works independently across the entire pipeline, from database architecture and engine code to final 3D rendering
- **Engine-Level Problem Solving:** modifies shaders, importers and rendering settings at engine level to solve pipeline problems at the root
- **Shipped Products:** commercial Blender tooling in active use, with support, updates and customers of its own
- **High-Profile Projects:** delivered work for Mercedes-Benz, Disney, Chevrolet, and licensed IPs (SpongeBob, Invader Zim, Tower of God)
- **Technical Leadership:** leads teams, mentors artists and juniors, and manages complex projects while staying hands-on
- **Performance Optimization:** optimizes assets and code for mobile, web and VR under strict real-time constraints